

```
</d>
<e>abc@xyz.com</e>
<p>1</p>
</c>
</a>
```

This is 159 characters, or an efficiency of approximately 64 per cent. In doing so, however, we lose the most important benefit of using XML in the first place: That is to make it easily readable by humans.

Often, when writing an AJAX application, the data is being transferred from the server to the client directly and doesn't need any human interpretation. The data is read by the client, is interpreted, and is then disposed of. As such, data being human readable isn't that important and other less verbose and more efficient formats are often adopted. The most important and popular one of them is JSON.

Another flaw that XML suffers from is that it requires significant processing before it can be used in the code. JSON, on the other hand, is JavaScript's native format of data, and as such requires little or no processing on the client side. In fact, since XML processing takes place in the background, a developer tends to use it excessively without being aware of how resource intensive it may be.

Conclusion

You now know enough on XML to come up with your own innovative methods for storing data. XML is flexible enough that you can keep incorporating new features without breaking old ones. However, it is also important to keep its flaws in mind.

Next, we will look at HTML, the basic platform on which you will create your AJAX application.